tripleten

Automation Upwork Job Hunt and Proposal Workflow with N8N

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AI Automation | Project 7

Introduction

- Project: Automate Upwork job discovery, scoring job and client, and proposal writing
- Role: Freelance Automation Engineer
- Goal: Identify high-quality jobs and generate proposals automatically
- Tools Used: n8n • OpenAI • Apify • Google Sheets • Telegram

Problem

- Manually searching Upwork jobs every day
- Opening each job description and client profile
- Judging job fit and client quality manually
- Writing or reusing proposals by hand
- Tracking jobs in spreadsheets manually

Challenges

- Time-consuming
- Inconsistent decision-making
- Easy to miss high-quality opportunities

Why This Process Matters

- Job hunting is repetitive and low-leverage work
- Poor client selection leads to wasted effort
- Inconsistent proposals reduce response rates

Goal

- Focus only on high-quality, high-fit opportunities
- Turn job hunting into a scalable, reliable system.

Solution

End-to-End Automation Flow

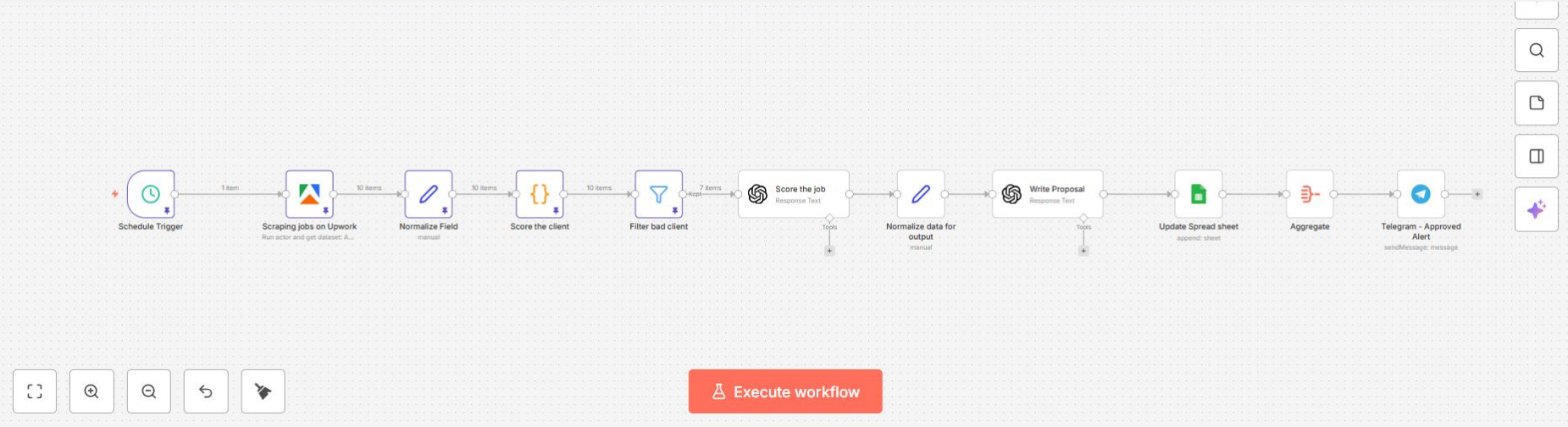
- Scheduled trigger runs daily
- Jobs scraped from Upwork using Apify
- Job and client data normalized
- Client quality scored using weighted logic

Continuation...

- Low-quality clients filtered out
- AI scores job relevance (1–5)
- AI generates tailored proposals
- Results saved to Google Sheets
- Telegram notification sent

N8N workflow diagram

Upwork Hunt: Score > 4-> AI Proposal + Sheets + Telegram



Data Sources

- Upwork job listings (via Apify)
- Job details: title, description, budget, job type
- Client data: rating, hire history, spend, payment verification

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1FZh52UJzYcw79MtKWKedHMlj57K8firm/view?usp=sharing

clientid Aa ab .* No results

```
"data": {
  "opening": {
    "info": {
      "notSureProjectDuration": false,
      "notSureFreelancersToHire": false,
      "notSureExperienceLevel": false,
      "notSureLocationPreference": false,
      "premium": false
    },
    "segmentationData": [
      {
        "customValue": null,
        "label": "Ongoing project",
        "name": "Employment",
        "sortOrder": 1,
        "type": "EMPLOYMENT",
        "value": "EMPLOYMENT_POSITION",
        "skill": null
      }
    ],
    "sandsData": {
      "occupation": {
        "freeText": null,
        "ontologyId": "upworkOccupation:fullstackdevelopment",
        "prefLabel": "Full Stack Development",
        "id": "1110580755107926016",
        "uid": "1110580755107926016"
      },
      "ontologySkills": [
        {
          "groupId": "1110580578754220032",
          "id": "1691099314245873665",
          "freeText": null,
          "prefLabel": "AI Agent Development",
          "groupPrefLabel": "Full Stack Development Deliverables",
          "relevance": "MANDATORY"
```

Client Scoring Logic

Automated Client Score (0–5)

Rating (35%)

Hire rate (25%)

Normalized spend (20%)

Repeat hire rate (10%)

Payment verified (10%)

Outcome

- Objective, explainable client-quality score

Edit JavaScript

Code ✨ Ask AI

```javascript
const spend = asNum($json.totalCharges, 0); // <-- nested amount

// Normalize
const rating01 = clamp((score5 || 4.0) / 5, 0, 1);
const hireRate01 = totalAssignments > 0 ? clamp(totalJobsWithHires / totalAssignments, 0, 1) : 0.6;
const normalizedSpend01 = clamp(spend / 10000, 0, 1);
const repeatHireRate01 = 0.3;

// If you have this field, use it; otherwise keep 0
const paymentVerified01 = $json['isPaymentMethodVerified '] === true ? 1 : 0;

// Weighted (0..1)
const clientScore01 =
  (0.35 * rating01) +
  (0.25 * hireRate01) +
  (0.20 * normalizedSpend01) +
  (0.10 * repeatHireRate01) +
  (0.10 * paymentVerified01);

// Final (0..5)
const clientScore = Number((clientScore01 * 5).toFixed(2));

return {
  ...$json,
  debug: { rating01, hireRate01, normalizedSpend01, repeatHireRate01, paymentVerified01, clientScore01 }
```

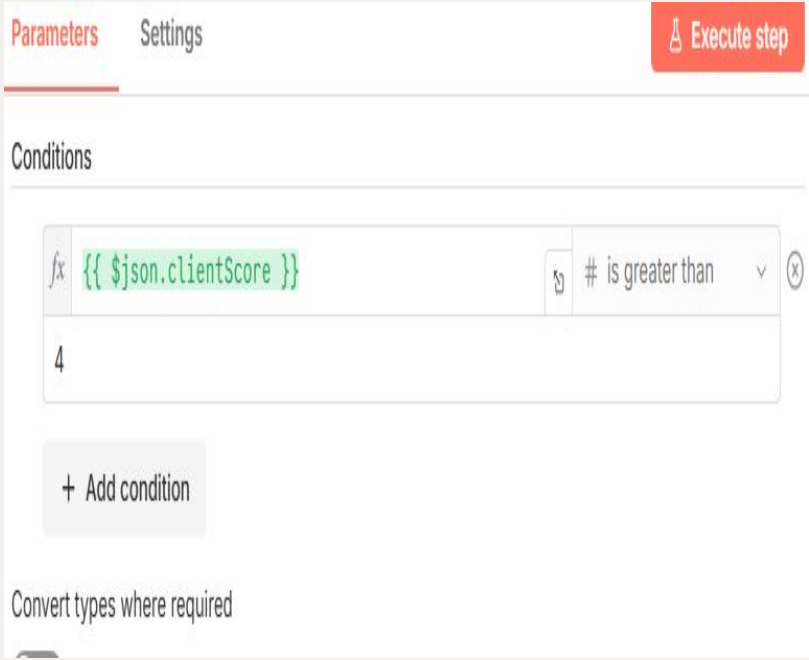
Quality Control: Filtering

Automatic Quality Gate

- Clients with low trust are rejected early
- Only jobs with clientScore > 4 continue

Why this is important

- Saves costs
- Protects time and focus
- Ensures only serious clients remain



AI Job Scoring

AI evaluates job relevance

- Match to n8n / automation expertise
- Budget requirements
- Contract type
- Client quality

Output

- Score from 1–5
- Explanation for transparency

Expression

Anything inside {{ }} is JavaScript. Learn more

```
You're an intelligent Upwork assistant that is great at
analyzing job
listings and finding the best matches for me!
Scoring them on a 1-5 point basis based on the follow
guidelines below,
while also taking into consideration my interests and what I'm
looking for
Here is the scoring guideline:
{{ $json.score }}
Please output the following data in JSON format with the
following structure:
{
"score": //1-5 points here
"explanation":
}
```

AI Proposal Generation

- AI rewrites a proven high-conversion proposal
- Preserves tone and structure
- Customizes content per job description

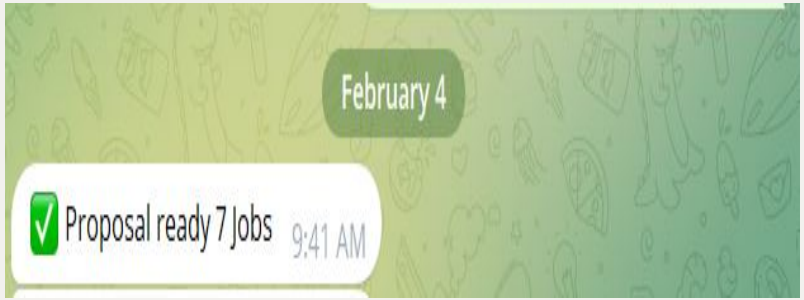
Expression

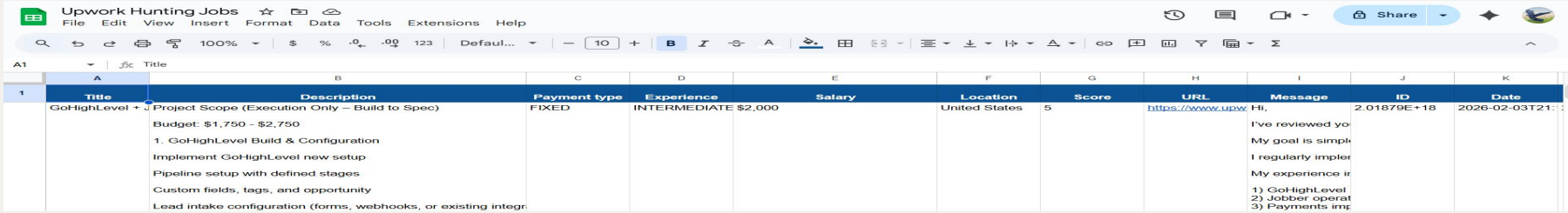
Anything inside {{ }} is JavaScript. Learn more

```
You are an expert assistant specialized in writing high-
conversion Upwork proposals.

Your task is to take the example proposal provided in the
assistant message and closely mirror its tone, structure, and
writing style. Adapt the proposal to the new job description
while keeping approximately 90% of the original wording
unchanged, modifying only what is necessary for relevance and
accuracy.

You must always follow this exact structure, in this order:
Intro
Goal
Portfolio Link
Examples of why I'm the perfect candidate
Skills
Conclusion

Strict rules:

Never use placeholder text of any kind (for example: client
names, job titles, or generic link markers).

Use plain text only. Do not use Markdown, HTML, symbols, or
special formatting.

Any list must be numbered using 1), 2), 3) format only
```

Outputs

- Approved jobs stored in Google Sheets
- Includes job details, score, proposal, and links
- Instant Telegram notifications when proposals are ready





Upwork Hunting Jobs

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help

A1 | Title

Title	Description	Payment type	Experience	Salary	Location	Score	URL	Message	ID	Date
GoHighLevel + J	Project Scope (Execution Only – Build to Spec) Budget: $1,750 - $2,750 1. GoHighLevel Build & Configuration Implement GoHighLevel new setup Pipeline setup with defined stages Custom fields, tags, and opportunity Lead intake configuration (forms, webhooks, or existing integr	FIXED	INTERMEDIATE	$2,000	United States	5	https://www.upw	Hi, I've reviewed yo My goal is simpl I regularly impler My experience ir 1) GoHighLevel 2) Jobber operat 3) Payments imp	2.01879E+18	2026-02-03T21:

Challenges & improvements

What Worked Well

Apify Actor

- Easy to setup and configure
- Provided clean, structured Upwork job data
- Eliminated the need for custom scraping logic

End-to-End Automation

- Workflow runs fully automatically on schedule
- From job discovery → scoring → proposal → notification

AI Proposal Generation

- Consistent, professional proposal structure
- Adapted content per job description
- Reduced manual writing time significantly

Challenges

Client Scoring

- Difficult to design accurate scoring due to missing or inconsistent client data
- Required normalization and manual weight tuning

Job Scoring (AI)

- Converting subjective relevance into a numeric score required prompt iteration
- Small prompt changes impacted scoring results

Telegram Setup

- Required extra configuration for formatting and aggregation
- Testing needed to ensure correct alert behavior

What I'd Improve With More Time

- Add a feedback loop based on proposal success
- Improve scoring accuracy using historical outcomes
- Add analytics dashboards for performance tracking
- Expand notifications (Slack / Email)
- Automate proposal submission

Conclusion

This project shows how AI and automation can transform a repetitive, manual job-search process into a scalable, data-driven system. While scoring logic required the most refinement, the overall workflow proved reliable and demonstrated real-world business value.